

SOC-211
SOLVED PAST PAPERS SPRING 2022
SOLVED BY

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(I)

Sociological Perspectives and Its Benefits

Sociology provides different perspectives to understand society and human behavior. The three main sociological perspectives are **functionalism, conflict theory, and symbolic interactionism**. Each perspective helps analyze social issues from different angles and provides valuable insights.

Benefits:

- Help in understanding human behavior and social structures.
- Provide solutions to social problems like inequality, crime, and discrimination.
- Assist governments and organizations in policy-making.
- Improve communication and relationships by understanding different viewpoints.

(II)

Values and Value Inconsistency

Values: Values are the core beliefs and principles that guide human behavior. They provide a standard for what is right or important in society. Example: Honesty, respect, and equality are common values.

Value Inconsistency: Value inconsistency occurs when there is a conflict between stated values and actual behavior. It shows a gap between ideals

and real-life actions. Example: A society promotes equality but still practices discrimination.

(III)

Subculture and Counterculture

Subculture: A group within a larger culture that has distinct values and practices but still follows the main culture is called subculture. It Coexists with mainstream society. It does not seek to change the dominant culture.

Example: Hip-hop culture, gamers, or religious communities.

Counterculture: A group that actively rejects and opposes the dominant culture's norms and values is called counterculture. It conflicts with mainstream society. It tries to challenge or replace existing cultural norms. It often seen as rebellious or threatening. **Example:** Hippie movement, anarchist groups, or extremist organizations.

(IV)

SOCIALIZATION AND ITS IMPORTANCE

Socialization is the lifelong process through which individuals learn the norms, values, behaviors, and social skills needed to become functioning members of society. It begins in childhood and continues throughout life, influenced by family, education, peers, media, and personal experiences.

Importance of Socialization

Socialization is essential because it shapes a person's identity and personality. It helps transmit cultural traditions from one generation to another, ensuring continuity in society. Through socialization, individuals learn how to interact with others, follow social rules, and develop moral and ethical values. It also prepares people for different social roles, including

work, relationships, and responsibilities, making it a crucial aspect of human development and social stability.

(V)

Media as an agent of Socialization

Media plays a powerful role in shaping individuals' thoughts, behaviors, and values. It includes television, social media, newspapers, films, and the internet, influencing people from a young age. Through media, individuals learn about cultural norms, social expectations, and global events. It helps in spreading information, shaping opinions, and even setting trends. However, media can also promote stereotypes, misinformation, and unrealistic standards. Despite its positive and negative effects, media remains one of the most influential agents of socialization in modern society, impacting how people think, behave, and interact with others.

(VI)

Latent functions of crime

Latent functions of crime are the unintended and sometimes hidden effects that crime has on society. While crime is generally seen as harmful, it can also have indirect benefits. For example, crime creates jobs in law enforcement, security, and legal professions. It can also bring attention to social injustices, leading to legal and social reforms. Additionally, crime sometimes strengthens social bonds, as communities unite to fight against it. Though crime is undesirable, its latent functions play a role in shaping society in unexpected ways.

LONG QUESTIONS

Q: 1 Describe in detail the theory of self by George Herbert Mead?

Introduction to G.H. Mead

George Herbert Mead (1863–1931) was an important thinker who helped develop the idea of symbolic interactionism. This theory explains how people learn the meanings of things through social interactions. His student, Herbert Blumer, later named this idea "symbolic interactionism." Mead believed that people understand the world and develop their personalities based on how they interact with others, especially during childhood.

What is "Self"?

According to Mead, the self is the way we see ourselves based on how others see us. It does not exist at birth but develops through social interactions. Different groups, such as family, friends, and society, shape our self-identity. Mead called this process "taking the role of the generalized other."

A scholar named Merrill also explained that the self is not fixed but changes over time. As people grow and experience new things, their personality develops. Our emotions, such as love and hate, also come from our interactions with society.

Mead's Theory of Self

Mead explained that self has two main parts:

1. The **"I"** – This is the part of us that is unique and spontaneous. It represents our personal choices and creativity.
2. The **"Me"** – This is the part of us that follows society's rules and expectations. It develops through interactions with others and is shaped by social norms.

The **"I"** and **"Me"** work together to form a complete personality. The **"I"** helps us express ourselves in our own way, while the **"Me"** helps us behave in ways that society expects.

Symbolic Interactionism and Socialization

Mead's ideas are similar to Cooley's looking-glass self, which says that we see ourselves based on how we think others view us. Mead believed that people learn who they are by interacting with others. Society gives meaning to objects, behaviors, and traditions, and we follow these meanings in our daily lives. For example, children learn to respect books, celebrate traditions, or follow family rules by observing and participating in social activities. This shows how social interactions help shape our identity and personality.

Q: 2 Define Language and describe in detail the functions and dysfunctions that a language may present?

Language

According to John J. Macionis:

"Language, the key to the world of culture, is a system of symbols that allows people to communicate with one another."

Humans have created many alphabets to express the hundreds of languages we speak.

A group of words or ideas having common meaning and shared in a social situation is called language. Language is the entrance to a culture. It is a set of socially sound patterns, words, and sentences with specific meanings and terminology common to the same culture. People saying "Hello" in different languages shows cultural diversity. You can learn the effects of ethnocentrism.

Language is a source of communication that helps transmit messages from one person to another. It shapes behavior and experience. Language differs from culture to culture and is passed down from one generation to another.

Language is like a vehicle that allows us to carry out complex social activities. It is the foundation of culture and the gateway to social life. Animals do not have culture because they lack a specific language to share their world with others. Therefore, language is the key to social life, helping individuals interact and connect with society.

Q: 3 What is a bureaucracy? Write down the ideal characteristics of a bureaucracy. Do you think that bureaucracies in Pakistan process these ideal characteristics?

Bureaucracy: Bureaucracy is an organizational system with a clear hierarchy, division of labor, set rules, and an impersonal approach to management. **Max Weber** studied how bureaucracies became more common, especially during the **Industrial Revolution**, as they helped improve efficiency and control. He believed bureaucracy was the most **rational** way to achieve organizational goals because it replaced traditional, informal methods with structured rules and procedures. Today, bureaucracies exist everywhere, from small colleges to large multinational corporations, shaping how organizations function.

Characteristics of Bureaucracy: Weber set forth several ideal-type characteristics of bureaucratic organizations. These characteristics have been elaborated as under.

i. Jurisdictional Competency

Jurisdictional competency is a key element of a bureaucratic organization, which is broken into units with defined responsibilities. Fundamentally, jurisdictional competency refers to bureaucratic specialization, with all

elements of a bureaucracy possessing a defined role. The responsibilities of individuals broaden with movement upward through an organizational hierarchy.

ii. Specific Functions

These kinds of organizations are set to perform specific functions.

iii. Norms and Codes

Every formal organization has its own norms and code of working, which are shared and every member is bound to follow. Violation of such code is highly undesirable.

iv. Authority

Formal organization is a big source of authority. Without authority, the concept of formal organization is impossible. All members are bound to follow the authority of the organizations.

v. Rationality

This organization is based on rationality, and decisions are taken on the basis of rationality.

vi. Relative Permanence

Formal organizations are relatively permanent. Some organizations last for a longer time, while others perish within a short period of time. Relatively few organizations survive for many generations.

vii. Specialization

Our ancestors spent most of their time performing the general task of looking for food.

viii. Hierarchy of Positions

Bureaucracies arrange workers in a vertical ranking.

ix. Rules and Regulations

Cultural tradition counts for little in a bureaucracy. Instead, rationally enacted rules and regulations guide a bureaucracy's operation. Ideally, a bureaucracy operates in a completely predictable way.

x. Technical Competence

Bureaucratic officials have the technical competence to carry out their duties. Bureaucracies typically hire new members according to set standards and then monitor their performance. Such impersonal evaluation contrasts with the ancient custom of favoring relatives, whatever their talents, over strangers.

xi. Impersonality

Bureaucracy puts rules ahead of personal whims so that both clients and workers are treated in the same way. From this impersonal approach comes the image of the “faceless bureaucrat.”

xii. Formal, Written Communications

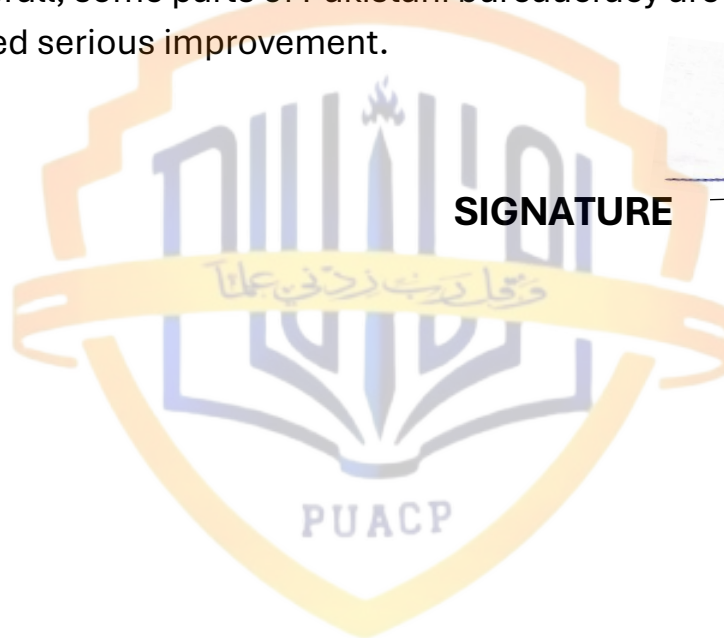
It is said that the heart of bureaucracy is not people but paperwork. Instead of the casual, face-to-face talk that characterizes interaction within small groups, bureaucracy relies on formal, written memos and reports, which accumulate in vast files.

Now, I think in my view Pakistani bureaucracy is not working as it should. The division of labor is based on merit, which is good, but many officials do not do their jobs properly and need to be held accountable. The system of authority is also weak because many powerful officials use their position for personal benefits instead of serving the country.

Rules and regulations are often ignored, especially in places like Pakistan Railways, where some employees mark their attendance but do not actually

work. Hiring based on qualifications is also a problem, as unqualified people are sometimes given important positions, leading to poor management. Many officials do not remain fair in their decisions and favor people they know instead of being neutral. Police officers also misuse their power by demanding bribes to register complaints, which is unfair and illegal.

Discipline is followed in some government departments, but only organizations like ISPR maintain strict rules. Written communication exists in offices, but many people do not follow it properly. Rational decision-making is used in some cases, like CSS exams, but is often ignored in other government processes. Overall, some parts of Pakistani bureaucracy are working, but many areas need serious improvement.



SIGNATURE

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Bilal', is written over a horizontal line. The signature is fluid and cursive.